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## EARLY YEARS

*Of course I was religious. I grew up in the church. My father is a preacher, my grandfather was a preacher, my great-grandfather was a preacher, my only brother is a preacher, my daddy's brother is a preacher. So I didn't have much choice.*

**NOVEMBER 25, 1926**
Michael (later Martin) Luther King, Sr., marries Alberta Williams, daughter of A. D. Williams, pastor of Ebenezer Baptist Church

**JANUARY 15, 1929**
Michael (later Martin) Luther King, Jr., born at Williams/King family home at 501 Auburn Avenue in Atlanta

**MARCH 21, 1931**
A. D. Williams dies and is succeeded as pastor of Ebenezer by King Sr.

**MAY 18, 1941**
King Jr.'s grandmother Jennie Celeste Williams dies and family moves to 193 Boulevard in Atlanta

**APRIL 17, 1944**
King Jr. travels to Dublin, Georgia, to deliver "The Negro and the Constitution" in oratory contest

I was born in the late twenties on the verge of the Great Depression, which was to spread its disastrous arms into every corner of this nation for over a decade. I was much too young to remember the beginning of this depression, but I do recall, when I was about five years of age, how I questioned my parents about the numerous people standing in breadlines. I can see the effects of this early childhood experience on my present anticapitalistic feelings.

My birthplace was Atlanta, Georgia, the capital of the state and the so-called "gateway to the South." Atlanta is home for me. I was born on Auburn Avenue. Our church, Ebenezer Baptist, is on Auburn Avenue. I'm